JUNIOR SCHOOL LEARNING HUB

GRADE 9 ENGLISH

DETAILED FULL-YEAR LEARNER NOTES

Terms 1, 2 and 3

Learner's Name: _____
Grade/Stream: _____
School: _____

Original teacher-prepared study resource | CBC-oriented learning support

How to use these notes

These notes develop the four language skills—Listening and Speaking, Reading, Grammar in Use and Writing—through familiar school, home and community contexts. The annual theme sequence is a planning guide; the exact class-reader text and detailed sub-strand sequence should be checked against the current Grade 9 KICD design and the title selected by the school.

- Read examples aloud and explain why a language choice is effective.
- Keep a vocabulary notebook with meanings, word classes, synonyms, antonyms and original sentences.
- Practise listening actively: identify purpose, main ideas, supporting details, tone and speaker attitude.
- Read different text types and support interpretations with evidence from the text.
- Draft, revise, edit and proofread writing rather than submitting the first draft.

Annual learning map

Term	Suggested context/theme clusters	Language focus
1	Identity, family, school life, relationships, community and culture	Listening for information; oral interaction; reading comprehension; vocabulary; sentence structure; paragraphs and personal/narrative writing
2	Environment, health, science, technology, work and enterprise	Listening to explanations and discussions; reading informational texts; grammar accuracy; reports, descriptions, explanations and functional writing
3	Citizenship, leadership, media, creativity, literature and future aspirations	Critical listening; interpretation of literary and media texts; language use in context; argument, speeches, reviews and examination writing

PART A: LISTENING AND SPEAKING

1. Listening for information and meaning

Listening is an active process of receiving spoken language, interpreting it and responding appropriately. Hearing is the physical ability to detect sound; listening requires attention and meaning-making.

1.1 Purposes of listening

Purpose	What the listener does
Listening for gist	Identifies the general subject or overall message

	without focusing on every word.
Listening for specific information	Listens for a particular name, date, place, instruction, number or fact.
Listening for detail	Records supporting points, explanations, examples and sequence.
Critical listening	Checks evidence, identifies bias, distinguishes fact from opinion and evaluates reliability.
Appreciative listening	Enjoys and responds to stories, poems, music, speeches and performances.

1.2 Active listening strategies

- Prepare by considering the topic and purpose.
- Face the speaker where appropriate and minimise distractions.
- Listen for signpost words such as firstly, however, because, finally and in conclusion.
- Identify the main idea and separate it from examples or minor details.
- Make brief notes using key words, abbreviations or a simple outline.
- Ask relevant clarification questions and summarise what you understood.
- Respond respectfully without interrupting or mocking the speaker.

1.3 Listening notes

Effective notes are brief and organised. Use headings, numbered points, keywords and symbols. Do not attempt to write every word. After listening, review the notes and fill gaps while the information is still fresh.

Example: A talk on water conservation may be organised as: problem (water shortage); causes (low rainfall, wastage, pollution); solutions (repair leaks, harvest rainwater, protect catchments); conclusion (shared responsibility).

Practice and self-check

1. Explain the difference between hearing and listening.
2. Name four purposes of listening.
3. Give three strategies for identifying the main ideas in a talk.
4. Why should a listener distinguish fact from opinion?

Suggested answers: Listening involves attention and interpretation, while hearing is detecting sound. Purposes include gist, specific information, detail, critical and appreciative listening. Listen for signposts, repeat key ideas mentally, take organised notes and summarise. Facts can be checked; opinions express a viewpoint.

2. Speaking, discussion and oral presentations

2.1 Effective oral communication

Speaking is the organised expression of ideas to communicate information, feelings, opinions or instructions. Effective speakers consider their audience, purpose, setting, content, language and delivery.

Feature	Good practice

Clarity	Pronounce words distinctly and use an appropriate pace.
Audibility	Speak loudly enough for the audience without shouting.
Fluency	Maintain a natural flow; pause meaningfully rather than filling every gap.
Vocabulary	Choose words appropriate to the topic, audience and situation.
Grammar	Use accurate sentence structures and suitable tenses.
Non-verbal communication	Use natural eye contact, posture, facial expression and gestures.
Organisation	Use an opening, logically ordered points and a clear conclusion.

2.2 Group discussion

A discussion is an exchange of ideas among two or more people. A successful discussion has a clear topic, shared purpose and agreed rules.

- Contribute relevant ideas and give reasons or examples.
- Listen to other contributions before responding.
- Disagree with an idea politely, not by attacking the person.
- Invite quieter members to contribute and avoid dominating.
- Ask questions that clarify or extend the discussion.
- Summarise areas of agreement and unresolved issues.

Useful expressions: “I agree with that point because…”, “I see the issue differently…”, “Could you clarify what you mean by…?”, “An example that supports this is…”, and “To summarise our discussion…”.

2.3 Oral presentations

5. Research the topic and select reliable information.
6. Identify the audience and decide what they should learn or do.
7. Arrange ideas into an introduction, main points and conclusion.
8. Prepare brief cue cards rather than reading a full script.
9. Practise pronunciation, timing, transitions and use of visual aids.
10. Deliver the presentation and respond politely to questions.

2.4 Debate

A debate is a structured discussion in which speakers present opposing positions on a motion. The proposition supports the motion; the opposition challenges it. A strong argument contains a claim, supporting reason, evidence or example, and explanation.

Example motion: “Schools should make environmental conservation a compulsory learner activity.” Claim: school conservation should be compulsory. Reason: regular action builds responsible habits. Evidence/example: learners can maintain tree nurseries and monitor waste separation. Explanation: practical participation turns awareness into action.

Practice and self-check

11. List five qualities of an effective speaker.
12. State four rules for productive group discussion.
13. What are the main parts of a speech?
14. Explain the difference between a claim and supporting evidence.

Suggested answers: Qualities include clarity, audibility, fluency, suitable vocabulary, correct grammar and audience awareness. Discussion rules include listening, relevance, respectful disagreement and fair participation. A speech has an introduction, organised body and conclusion. A claim is a position; evidence supports it.

PART B: READING

3. Reading comprehension and critical reading

Reading involves recognising written words, constructing meaning, making inferences and evaluating ideas. Good readers use the title, headings, illustrations, context and prior knowledge to understand a text, but they confirm interpretations using evidence in the text.

3.1 Reading strategies

Strategy	How to apply it
Previewing	Look at the title, headings, layout, captions and source before reading.
Skimming	Read quickly to identify the overall topic and main idea.
Scanning	Search for a specific fact, date, name, figure or keyword.
Close reading	Read carefully to understand details, vocabulary, relationships and evidence.
Predicting	Use clues to anticipate what may follow, then confirm or revise the prediction.
Inferring	Combine clues in the text with reasonable background knowledge.
Summarising	Restate the central ideas briefly in your own words.

3.2 Main ideas and supporting details

The main idea is the central point a paragraph or text communicates. Supporting details explain, prove, illustrate or develop that point. A topic sentence often states the main idea, but it may also appear later or be implied.

Example: “Trees improve the environment. They provide shade, absorb carbon dioxide, reduce soil erosion and create habitats.” Main idea: trees benefit the environment. Supporting details: shade, carbon dioxide absorption, erosion control and habitats.

3.3 Inference, tone and purpose

- Inference: a conclusion suggested by clues rather than directly stated.
- Tone: the writer's or speaker's attitude, such as serious, humorous, hopeful, critical or persuasive.
- Purpose: the reason for creating the text—to inform, entertain, persuade, instruct, describe or explain.
- Audience: the people for whom the text is intended; this affects vocabulary, detail and style.
- Bias: a one-sided presentation that favours a particular viewpoint.

3.4 Vocabulary in context

When you meet an unfamiliar word, examine nearby words, examples, contrasts, definitions and the overall topic. A prefix is added at the beginning of a word; a suffix is added at the end; a root carries the central meaning. A dictionary helps confirm spelling, pronunciation, word class and meaning.

Word-building element	Meaning / example
un-	Often means not or opposite: unhappy
re-	Means again: rewrite
pre-	Means before: preview
-ful	Means full of: careful
-less	Means without: careless
-ment	Forms a noun: development
-tion	Often forms a noun: education

3.5 Summarising

15. Read the whole passage to understand its subject.
16. Identify the main points and remove repeated examples or minor details.
17. Use your own words while retaining the author's meaning.
18. Write in a logical order and keep within the required length.
19. Check that no personal opinion or unsupported information has been added.

Practice and self-check

20. Distinguish skimming from scanning.
21. What is an inference?
22. How can context help a reader understand a new word?
23. State four steps in writing a good summary.

Suggested answers: Skimming finds the gist; scanning locates a specific detail. An inference is a conclusion drawn from textual clues. Context supplies surrounding clues and examples. Read, select main points, paraphrase accurately and check length and meaning.

4. Literary and imaginative texts

4.1 Elements of a short story

Element	Explanation
Plot	The sequence of events in a story, often involving

	a conflict and its resolution.
Setting	The time and place in which events occur.
Character	A person, animal or figure in a story; characterisation shows qualities through actions, speech and thoughts.
Conflict	A struggle between opposing forces, such as person versus person, society, nature or self.
Theme	A central idea explored by the text, such as honesty, courage or responsibility.
Narrator	The voice that tells the story; do not automatically assume the narrator is the author.
Style	The writer's choices of language, imagery, sentence structure and narrative technique.

4.2 Poetry

A poem uses carefully selected language, sound, rhythm, imagery and structure to communicate ideas and feelings. A line is a single row of a poem; a stanza is a group of lines.

Device	Meaning	Example
Simile	Comparison using like or as	“Her smile was like sunshine.”
Metaphor	Direct comparison	“Time is a thief.”
Personification	Giving human qualities to non-human things	“The wind whispered.”
Alliteration	Repetition of initial consonant sounds	“Wild winds whistle.”
Onomatopoeia	Words that imitate sounds	buzz, splash, bang
Repetition	Repeating words or phrases for emphasis	“Never give up, never give in.”
Imagery	Language that creates sensory pictures	“The warm, spicy aroma filled the room.”

When analysing a poem, identify the speaker, situation, mood, theme, images, sound devices and structure. Explain the effect of a device in context; do not merely name it.

4.3 Drama

Drama is a literary form written for performance. It uses dialogue, action, characters, setting, stage directions and conflict. A script may divide action into acts and scenes. Stage directions guide movement, expression, sound, lighting and other performance details.

When studying a play, trace how a character's choices influence events, how dialogue reveals relationships, and how conflict develops. Support interpretations with short references to events or dialogue.

4.4 Studying a class reader

Use the actual class-reader title selected by the school. Keep a reading log with chapter or section, events, characters introduced, important quotations or references, new vocabulary, themes and questions. Do not rely on summaries alone: read the original text and use evidence to support answers.

Practice and self-check

24. Define plot, setting, theme and conflict.
25. Distinguish a simile from a metaphor.
26. Identify the figure of speech in “The moon smiled at us.”
27. Name four features of drama.
28. Why should literary answers refer to events in the text?

Suggested answers: Plot is the sequence of events; setting is time and place; theme is a central idea; conflict is a struggle. A simile uses like/as; a metaphor makes a direct comparison. The moon smiled is personification. Drama includes dialogue, characters, stage directions and acts/scenes. Textual references make interpretations verifiable.

PART C: GRAMMAR IN USE

5. Parts of speech and sentence structure

5.1 Parts of speech

Word class	Function	Example
Noun	Names a person, place, thing or idea	teacher, Nairobi, desk, courage
Pronoun	Replaces a noun	she, they, ours, who
Verb	Expresses action, occurrence or state	write, grow, is
Adjective	Describes or limits a noun/pronoun	bright, careful, three
Adverb	Modifies a verb, adjective or adverb	slowly, very, yesterday
Preposition	Shows relationships, often of place, time or direction	under, during, towards
Conjunction	Joins words, phrases or clauses	and, but, because
Interjection	Expresses sudden feeling	Oh! Hurray!

5.2 Phrases and clauses

A phrase is a group of words that functions as a unit but does not contain a complete subject–finite verb structure. A clause contains a subject and a verb. An independent clause can stand as a complete sentence; a dependent clause cannot stand alone.

Examples: “after the lesson” is a prepositional phrase; “the learners completed the task” is an independent clause; “because the rain had stopped” is a dependent clause.

5.3 Sentence types by structure

Type	Structure	Example
Simple	One independent clause	The learners revised.
Compound	Two or more independent clauses joined correctly	The bell rang, and the learners left.
Complex	One independent clause and at least one dependent clause	The learners left when the bell rang.
Compound-complex	At least two independent clauses and one or more dependent clauses	When the bell rang, the learners left, and the teacher closed the room.

5.4 Sentence types by purpose

- Declarative: makes a statement. Example: The class begins at eight.
- Interrogative: asks a question. Example: When does the class begin?
- Imperative: gives a command or request. Example: Please open your book.
- Exclamatory: expresses strong feeling. Example: What a wonderful performance!

5.5 Subject–verb agreement

The verb must agree with its subject in person and number. A singular subject generally takes a singular verb in the present tense; a plural subject takes a plural verb.

Correct form	Reason
The learner writes neatly.	Singular subject learner; singular verb writes.
The learners write neatly.	Plural subject learners; base verb write.
Each of the players is ready.	Each is singular.
The teacher, together with the learners, is present.	The main subject is teacher; intervening phrase does not change it.
Neither the boys nor the girl is late.	With neither/nor, agreement commonly follows the nearer subject in this construction.

Common error: “The list of names are long.” Correct: “The list of names is long.” The subject is list, not names.

5.6 Tenses

Tense	Use	Example
Simple present	Habits, facts and regular actions	She reads every evening.
Present continuous	Action happening now or around now	She is reading now.
Present perfect	Past action linked to the present	She has read the chapter.
Simple past	Completed action in the past	She read yesterday.

Past continuous	Action in progress at a past time	She was reading at six.
Past perfect	Earlier of two past actions	She had read before the lesson began.
Simple future	Future action or prediction	She will read tomorrow.
Future continuous	Action in progress at a future time	She will be reading at six.

Maintain tense consistency unless the time or meaning changes. Irregular verbs do not form the past tense simply by adding -ed: go/went/gone; write/wrote/written; see/saw/seen.

5.7 Active and passive voice

In the active voice, the subject performs the action: “The learners planted trees.” In the passive voice, the subject receives the action: “Trees were planted by the learners.” Passive voice is useful when the action or result is more important than the doer, or when the doer is unknown.

To form a passive sentence, use the appropriate form of be + past participle, keeping the tense: “They clean the room” → “The room is cleaned”; “They cleaned the room” → “The room was cleaned.”

5.8 Direct and reported speech

Direct speech gives the speaker's exact words in quotation marks: Amina said, “I am ready.” Reported speech reports the message without quoting the exact words: Amina said that she was ready.

- Pronouns may change to match the reporter's viewpoint.
- Verb tense often moves back when the reporting verb is in the past, where appropriate: am → was; will → would; have → had.
- Time and place expressions may change: today → that day; tomorrow → the following day; here → there.
- Questions are reported using statement word order: He asked where I lived, not “where did I live”.
- Commands can be reported with told/asked + object + to-infinitive: She told us to wait.

5.9 Punctuation and capitalisation

Mark	Use
Full stop (.)	Ends a statement or command.
Comma (,)	Separates items, introductory elements and some clauses; avoid joining two complete sentences with only a comma.
Question mark (?)	Ends a direct question.
Exclamation mark (!)	Shows strong feeling or emphasis; use sparingly in formal writing.
Apostrophe (')	Shows possession or omitted letters: the learner's book; don't.
Quotation marks	Enclose direct speech or quoted words.
Colon (:)	Introduces an explanation, list or example after a

	complete clause.
Semicolon (;)	Links closely related independent clauses or separates complex list items.

Capital letters are used at the beginning of sentences, for the pronoun I, proper nouns, names of languages and nationalities, days, months and official titles when appropriate.

Practice and self-check

29. Identify the word class of carefully in “She worked carefully.”
30. Distinguish a phrase from a clause.
31. Change “The learners clean the laboratory” into passive voice.
32. Report: Peter said, “I will come tomorrow.”
33. Choose the correct verb: Each of the books (is/are) useful.
34. Correct the punctuation: where are you going asked mary

Suggested answers: Carefully is an adverb. A phrase lacks a complete subject–finite verb structure; a clause has one. The laboratory is cleaned by the learners. Peter said that he would come the following day. Each of the books is useful. “Where are you going?” asked Mary.

6. Vocabulary development and word relationships

6.1 Synonyms and antonyms

A synonym is a word with the same or nearly the same meaning as another word; an antonym has an opposite meaning. Synonyms are not always interchangeable because tone, formality and context differ.

Word	Possible synonym	Antonym
courageous	brave	cowardly
ancient	old	modern
generous	giving	selfish
expand	increase	contract
scarce	limited	abundant

6.2 Homophones, homonyms and commonly confused words

Words	Meaning / use
there / their / they're	place / belonging to them / they are
your / you're	belonging to you / you are
its / it's	possessive form / it is or it has
to / too / two	preposition or infinitive marker / also or excessively / number 2
principal / principle	head of a school or main / rule or moral standard
advice / advise	noun / verb
affect / effect	usually verb meaning influence / usually noun

	meaning result

6.3 Idioms, proverbs and figurative expressions

An idiom is an expression whose overall meaning cannot always be understood from the literal meanings of its words. A proverb is a short traditional saying that expresses advice or a general truth.

Expression	Meaning
A blessing in disguise	Something that seems bad at first but brings a benefit
Once in a blue moon	Very rarely
Actions speak louder than words	Behaviour is more convincing than promises
A stitch in time saves nine	Early action can prevent a bigger problem
Practice makes perfect	Repeated effort improves performance

6.4 Register and appropriate language

Register is the level or style of language used in a particular situation. Formal language is suitable for official letters, reports and professional settings. Informal language is common in friendly conversations and personal messages. Choose language according to audience, purpose and context.

Practice and self-check

35. Give a synonym and antonym for “generous”.
36. Explain the difference between their and they're.
37. What is an idiom? Give an example.
38. Why is register important?

Suggested answers: Synonym: giving/kind; antonym: selfish. Their means belonging to them; they're means they are. An idiom is an expression with a non-literal overall meaning, e.g. once in a blue moon. Register makes language suitable for the audience and situation.

PART D: WRITING

7. The writing process and paragraph development

7.1 Stages of writing

39. Planning: understand the task, audience, purpose and required format; brainstorm and organise ideas.
40. Drafting: write the first version, concentrating on meaning and logical flow.
41. Revising: improve ideas, organisation, clarity, evidence and paragraph order.
42. Editing: correct grammar, vocabulary, sentence structure and punctuation.
43. Proofreading: check spelling, capitalisation, layout, names, dates and final presentation.

7.2 Paragraph structure

A well-developed paragraph usually has a topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding or linking sentence. Unity means all sentences support one main idea. Coherence means ideas connect logically.

Example paragraph: “School gardens are valuable learning spaces. Learners can observe germination, practise measuring and study soil conservation. The harvest may also support nutrition projects. Therefore, a well-managed school garden connects classroom knowledge with practical life.”

7.3 Linking words

Purpose	Examples
Adding information	also, furthermore, in addition, moreover
Showing contrast	however, although, whereas, on the other hand
Giving reason	because, since, as
Showing result	therefore, consequently, as a result
Sequencing	first, next, afterwards, finally
Giving examples	for example, for instance, such as
Concluding	in conclusion, to sum up, overall

8. Functional writing

8.1 Formal letter

A formal letter is used for official communication. Use a clear layout, polite tone, concise paragraphs and accurate details. Follow the exact layout required by the teacher or examination.

Typical parts: sender's address and date; recipient's address; salutation; subject/reference where appropriate; opening paragraph stating purpose; body paragraphs giving relevant details; closing paragraph stating the expected action or appreciation; complimentary close; signature and full name.

Keep the subject line brief. Avoid slang, unnecessary abbreviations and emotional language. Check names, titles, dates and addresses carefully.

8.2 Informal letter

An informal letter is written to a friend or relative. It may use a friendly greeting and conversational tone, but it should still be organised and correctly punctuated. Begin by establishing contact, develop the message in paragraphs and close warmly.

8.3 Email

A useful email has a meaningful subject line, suitable greeting, clear message, courteous closing and correct recipient details. Keep the message focused. Do not type the whole message in capital letters, share private information unnecessarily or open suspicious attachments.

8.4 Report writing

A report presents information about an event, activity, investigation or situation in an organised and factual way. A school report may include a title, to/from/date/subject details, purpose, procedure or

method, findings, conclusion and recommendations. Use headings and numbered points where useful. Distinguish observed facts from assumptions.

8.5 Minutes

Minutes are an official record of the main proceedings and decisions of a meeting. They are not a word-for-word transcript. Include organisation or group name, meeting number, date, venue, members present, apologies, agenda items, key discussions, decisions, action points, responsible persons, closing time and confirmation at the next meeting. Use neutral, concise language.

8.6 Instructions and procedures

Procedural writing explains how to complete a task. It normally has a title, materials or requirements, and steps in chronological order. Use command verbs such as measure, place, connect, stir, record and check. Include warnings where safety matters.

8.7 Notices and announcements

A notice gives essential information briefly. It should make clear what is happening, who is concerned, the date, time, venue and any action required. Use a visible heading and avoid unnecessary detail.

Practice and self-check

44. List the five main stages of the writing process.
45. What makes a paragraph coherent?
46. Name six parts commonly found in a formal letter.
47. Why should minutes record decisions and action points?
48. What information should a notice communicate?

Suggested answers: Planning, drafting, revising, editing and proofreading. Coherence comes from logical order and links between sentences. Formal letter parts include addresses/date, salutation, subject, body, closing and signature. Minutes provide an accurate record of decisions and responsibilities. A notice states event, audience, date, time, venue and required action.

9. Creative and argumentative writing

9.1 Narrative composition

A narrative tells a story. It usually has an engaging opening, setting, characters, a sequence of events, a central conflict, a climax and a resolution. Use varied sentence structures, vivid but relevant description and dialogue that sounds natural.

- Plan the plot before writing; ensure events connect logically.
- Use past tense consistently unless there is a reason to shift.
- Show character through actions, speech and decisions.
- Use paragraphs to mark changes in speaker, time, place or focus.
- Avoid introducing too many events that do not contribute to the central story.

9.2 Descriptive composition

Descriptive writing creates a clear impression of a person, place, object or experience. Use sensory details—sight, sound, smell, taste and touch—along with precise vocabulary and comparisons. Organise the description spatially or by importance rather than listing random details.

9.3 Expository and explanatory writing

Expository writing explains a topic clearly. Begin with a focused introduction, arrange points in logical order, explain key terms and use examples. A process explanation should show stages and relationships, not simply list facts.

9.4 Argumentative and persuasive writing

Argumentative writing presents a position and supports it with reasons and evidence. Persuasive writing also seeks to influence the audience and may use rhetorical questions, repetition, emotional appeal and direct address. Strong persuasion remains fair and avoids misleading claims.

Useful structure: introduction with position; paragraph 1 with reason and evidence; paragraph 2 with another reason; paragraph acknowledging and responding to a counterargument; conclusion reinforcing the position.

9.5 Speech writing

A speech is written for oral delivery. Address the audience appropriately, introduce the topic, develop clear points, use transitions and end with a memorable conclusion or call to action. Use language that sounds natural when spoken.

9.6 Review writing

A review evaluates a book, performance, film or event. Identify the work, give a brief overview without revealing unnecessary plot details, discuss strengths and limitations with examples, and give a justified overall judgement. Separate personal preference from reasoned evaluation.

Practice and self-check

49. State four features of a good narrative.
50. How does descriptive writing differ from expository writing?
51. What should an argumentative paragraph contain?
52. Name four features of an effective speech.
53. Why should a review support opinions with examples?

Suggested answers: A narrative has setting, characters, plot, conflict and resolution. Description creates an impression through sensory detail; exposition explains information. An argumentative paragraph contains a claim, reason, evidence/example and explanation. A speech has audience awareness, clear structure, transitions, suitable oral language and a strong conclusion. Examples make evaluations credible.

PART E: THEMES AND APPLIED LANGUAGE

10. Applying language to familiar themes

Use the following theme areas as contexts for integrated language practice. The examples are learning prompts, not a claim that these are the exact verbatim KICD theme titles or sub-strands.

Theme cluster	Vocabulary and language tasks	Possible writing/speaking task
Identity and relationships	qualities, values, respect, empathy, responsibility	Give a short talk on positive peer relationships.
School and learning	goals, resources, collaboration,	Write a report on a class

	achievement	learning activity.
Environment	conservation, biodiversity, pollution, sustainability	Write an argumentative essay on reducing plastic waste.
Health and well-being	nutrition, hygiene, prevention, safety	Prepare an informative speech on healthy habits.
Science and technology	innovation, evidence, communication, digital safety	Explain how a useful technology works.
Work and enterprise	skills, occupation, budgeting, entrepreneurship	Write a formal letter requesting information about a career.
Citizenship and leadership	rights, duties, integrity, participation	Debate the value of responsible leadership.
Media and information	source, credibility, bias, privacy, misinformation	Compare two reports of the same event.
Culture and creativity	heritage, performance, identity, expression	Write a review of a cultural performance.
Future aspirations	pathways, interests, strengths, planning	Deliver a speech about a personal learning goal.

11. Examination and assessment skills

- Read the instruction words carefully: define, state, identify, explain, compare, discuss, summarise and evaluate require different responses.
- For comprehension, answer from the passage when the question asks according to the passage; do not substitute outside knowledge.
- For grammar, read the entire sentence and check meaning, tense, agreement and punctuation.
- For summary, observe the required length and use your own words without changing meaning.
- For composition, plan quickly, keep to the topic, organise paragraphs and reserve time to proofread.
- For oral tasks, practise aloud and use a clear pace, pronunciation and audience awareness.

Instruction word	What is expected
State / name	Give a brief fact or item.
Define	Give the precise meaning of a term.
Identify	Point out or select the required feature.
Describe	Give relevant characteristics or details.
Explain	Show how or why, with reasons.
Compare	Show similarities and/or differences.
Discuss	Examine several aspects in an organised way.
Summarise	Give only the main points concisely.
Evaluate	Make a judgement using reasons or evidence.

12. Editing checklist

- Does every paragraph have a clear purpose?
- Are ideas in a logical order with suitable linking words?
- Do subjects and verbs agree?
- Are verb tenses consistent and appropriate?
- Are pronouns clear and correctly matched to their references?
- Are spelling, punctuation and capital letters correct?
- Is the register suitable for the audience and task?
- Have repeated or irrelevant ideas been removed?
- Have names, dates, headings and layout been checked?

13. End-of-Year Revision Tasks

54. Listen to a short news report and write its main idea, three supporting details and the speaker's likely purpose.
55. Prepare a two-minute oral presentation on one way learners can improve their school environment.
56. Read a short article and identify its audience, purpose, tone, main idea and two supporting details.
57. Write a paragraph explaining why active listening is important in group work.
58. Change five active sentences into passive voice while preserving their tenses.
59. Convert five examples of direct speech into reported speech.
60. Write a formal letter to a relevant school official proposing an improvement to the learning environment.
61. Write a narrative composition ending with the sentence: “That day taught me the value of honesty.”
62. Write an argumentative composition on whether learners should take part in community service.
63. Review a book, play or performance you have studied, supporting your judgement with evidence.

14. Suggested assessment rubric

Skill	Strong performance	Developing performance
Listening	Accurately identifies gist, details, tone and purpose; responds appropriately.	Misses key information or needs repeated clarification.
Speaking	Clear, organised, fluent and audience-aware; supports ideas with examples.	Ideas are unclear, poorly organised or difficult to hear.
Reading	Uses evidence, makes sound inferences and evaluates ideas.	Relies on unsupported guesses or misses main ideas.
Grammar	Uses accurate structures and explains choices in context.	Frequent errors affect meaning or consistency.
Writing	Purposeful, coherent, well-developed and carefully edited.	Weak organisation, limited development or frequent language errors.

Curriculum and teacher-use note

This is an original teacher-prepared Grade 9 English learning resource organised around the four broad language skills used in the annual planning framework: Listening and Speaking, Reading, Grammar in Use and Writing. The school should verify exact Grade 9 KICD strand and sub-strand wording, lesson sequence, learning outcomes and any prescribed text against the current official Grade 9 English Curriculum Design. The school-selected class-reader title has deliberately not been assumed. This resource supplements, and does not replace, the official curriculum design, approved learner materials and teacher guidance.

Learners should practise the skills regularly using age-appropriate local texts, oral activities, class-reader extracts and teacher feedback. All sample texts and examples in these notes are original teaching examples.